ART FIBER SYSTEMS CHALLENGE · TEAM HELIOS

AFS Spectroscopy Assistant

From an in-line spectroscopy enquiry to a cited first technical assessment, with every quote checked against its page.

TEAM HELIOS · OCTOBER 2026

A good first answer is hard to write, and easy to get wrong

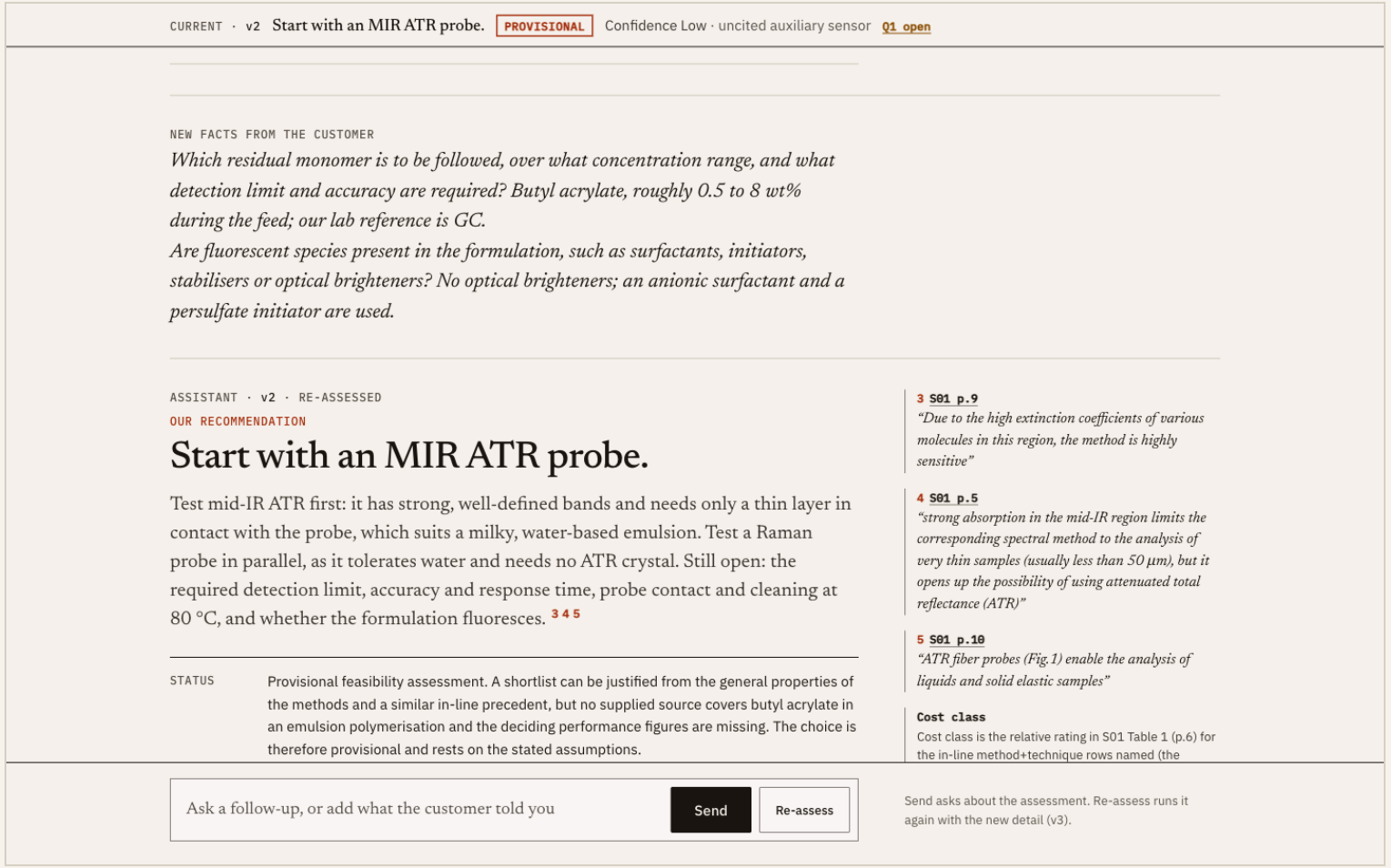
- Customers ask: *“we want to follow X in our process. Which method and probe should we test first?”*
- A useful first answer screens UV-Vis, NIR, MIR, Raman and fluorescence against the sample, probe and fiber limits. It proposes one option to test first and says what would change the choice.
- It must rest on the AFS materials. It must never invent accuracy, detection limits, response times, fiber lengths or prices, and never promise approval.

JUDGING CRITERION	WEIGHT
Technical quality	30
AFS grounding	20
Feasibility plan	15
Clarification and uncertainty	15
Explainability	10
Prototype	10

Every item of our eval checklist maps to one of these criteria.

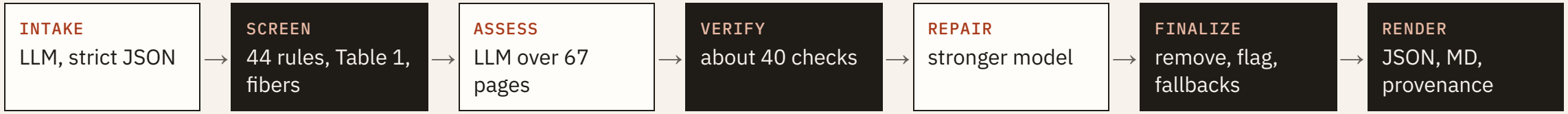
A chat that answers like a careful applications engineer

- The **recommendation headline** is built by code from the proposed option.
- Status, confidence and the next step. Margin notes show each verified quote with its page: `S01 p.9`
- Two or three options (simple / recommended / extended), each with a cost class from S01 Table 1 (p.6), never a price.
- Open questions, each linked to the option it would change.
- Follow-ups and re-assessment in the same thread. Each new turn opens with “What changed”.



Screenshot: docs/ui/brief-answer-1440.png (uv run afs-assist ui)

Models write. Code checks every quote, number and word.



120/120
H01–H06 citations verified on the cited page

0
hard verification failures in H01–H06

100%
citations verified in each of the 19 gate-run cases

19/19
gate-run external replays equal

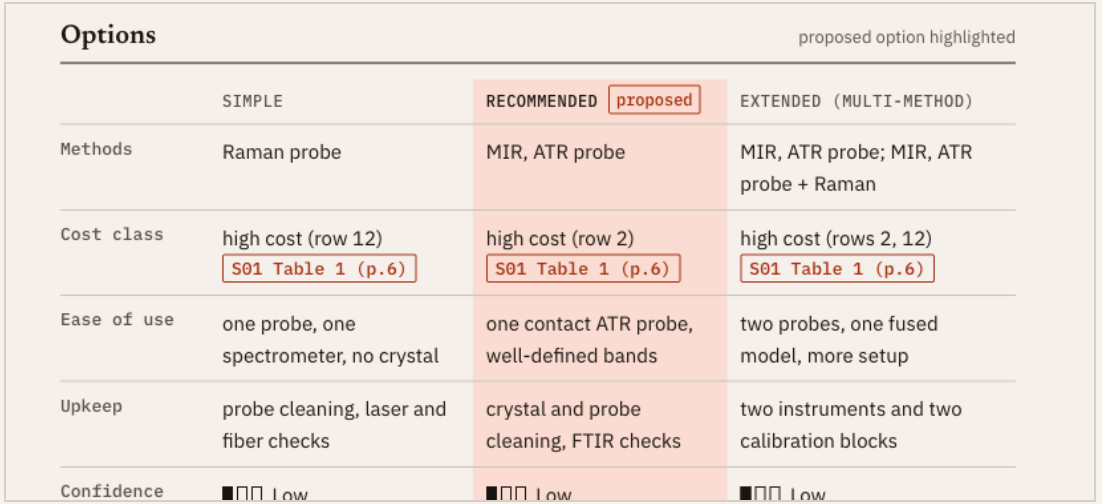
- A quote counts only if it is an exact or loose match on the cited page. A fuzzy near match is not verified, and a changed number or negation never matches.
- The page scope must fit the claim kind. Numbers come only from that claim's own quotes or the enquiry. No prices, no guarantee or approval wording.

Follow-ups get checked answers, and results arrive as blocks

- Routing is code: the first message assesses, new facts re-assess, any other text asks.
- An ask is one model call. Each claim gets the pipeline checks. A claim that fails is removed, and the answer says so.
- The server renders the blocks (options, setup, parameters, questions, risks, plan, sources, what changed) from the verified run. The model only names them.

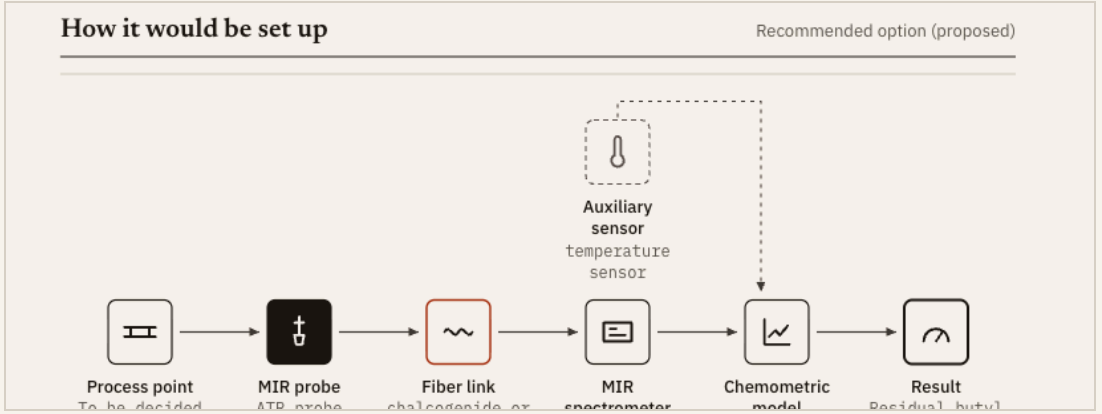
10/11	1.4–6.3 s	$0.038
citations verified (1 dropped by the checks)	per question	for 10 questions

Price question → cost class only and a quotation next step. Prompt injection → no guarantee. A question the sources do not cover (lifetime) → “not in the supplied sources” and a next step.



Options — proposed option highlighted

	SIMPLE	RECOMMENDED proposed	EXTENDED (MULTI-METHOD)
Methods	Raman probe	MIR, ATR probe	MIR, ATR probe; MIR, ATR probe + Raman
Cost class	high cost (row 12) S01 Table 1 (p.6)	high cost (row 2) S01 Table 1 (p.6)	high cost (rows 2, 12) S01 Table 1 (p.6)
Ease of use	one probe, one spectrometer, no crystal	one contact ATR probe, well-defined bands	two probes, one fused model, more setup
Upkeep	probe cleaning, laser and fiber checks	crystal and probe cleaning, FTIR checks	two instruments and two calibration blocks
Confidence	■□□ Low	■□□ Low	■□□ Low



One method first; combine only when one is not enough

- The extended option combines methods only for a target or interference that one method cannot cover `S01 p.7`. Mid-IR and Raman are complementary `S01 p.11`.
- A combined option must carry a fusion note:
  - same spot and volume `S01 p.8`;
  - data on a common time step `S01 p.8`;
  - one model per method first, then the fusion level.
- A chemometrics note says that calibration needs reference data, which is why accuracy is never promised before a feasibility study.

- Literature runs **only for gaps** the AFS sources leave open.
- It searches the curated open-access library (9 entries), then Europe PMC, OpenAlex and Unpaywall, all keyless. A guard keeps names and numbers from the enquiry out of the queries.
- Quotes are verbatim (at most 400 characters) and shown as *secondary*, with URL and licence. They are cached and replayable offline.

6	4–7 s	≤$0.0014
verified items in H01–H06 (1 dropped)	external step per case	external cost per case

7 arms, blind-judged against the AFS data

ARM (D01–D08)	QUALITY 1–5	S / CASE	$ / CASE	SOURCE RECALL
deepseek-v4.1-flash-1017	4.15	259	0.013	78 %
baseline v4.1-flash	4.08	504	0.022	82 %
mix-a (chosen)	**4.06**	**84**	**0.030**	**85 %**
glm-5.3-flash	3.96	322	0.006	85 %
gemini-3.8-flash	3.75	173	0.059	82 %
mix-b	3.38	69	0.030	75 %
gemini-3.5-flash-lite	3.23	29	0.015	65 %

- The top three tie on quality. **mix-a** is 3–6× faster than the other two.
- **mix-a** uses:
  - Gemini 3.5 Flash-Lite for intake and literature;
  - GLM-5.3-Flash to write the assessment;
  - Gemini 3.8 Flash to repair, only when the checks fail.
- Every role retries a cut-off or timed-out reply on another model.
- All arms had 0 hard failures. Four blind judges saw anonymous letters.

H01–H06, run once on tag freeze-1

6/6	120/120	97–184s	$0.288
complete; 0 hard failures, 0 runaways, 0 timeouts	citations verified	per case	for all six cases

- Status: premise_not_supported ×4, provisional ×1, insufficient_information ×1. Each is justified by a cited source.
- External replay 13/13 equal. Cost class matches S01 Table 1 in 6/6 cases.
- Independent rule-compliance review: **PASS WITH CAVEATS**, no blocking violation.
- Dev D01–D08 + adversarial A01–A12: checklist **0 failures**.
- Adversarial must 33/34 and must-not 12/13. Both misses are A07 (over-questioning). They are recorded, and the eval was not changed after seeing the outputs.
- 758 offline tests pass (2 skipped), in a fresh clone too.

What it does not do yet

- **Too long:** 3,058–3,455 words per H output, against 303–400 words in the AFS worked answers.
- **“Verified” means the quote is on the page and in scope**, not that it supports the claim. There is no entailment check yet.
- Short table cells and page references typed inline are not checked. Fields are not checked against each other.
- A literature item can be tagged to the wrong option or be only weakly relevant.
- A complete enquiry can still get 4–5 questions (A07).
- Confidence rarely varies: 45 of 55 options were Low in the G5 review.
- A follow-up can flip the method without a clear reason.
- A full assessment takes about 1.5–3 minutes, and the flex tier can queue.

Next

- An entailment critic: does the quote really support the claim?
- A short customer reply that matches the length of the AFS worked answers.
- Checks on table cells, inline page references and fields against each other.
- Calibrated confidence and fewer questions on complete enquiries.

```
uv sync
uv run afs-assist ui
uv run afs-assist assess --text "…"
uv run afs-assist eval
uv run pytest
```

README.md · ARCHITECTURE.md · DEVIATIONS.md (every change from plan, logged)